

coordinate actions between various providers in order to ensure a consistent strategy on all fronts. Other professionals who may be part of this team include accountants, elder-law attorneys, and long-term care coordinators. As for estate planning, aspects to consider include reviewing one's values and objectives for a legacy plan, having a streamlined financial plan in place for survivors, properly titling assets and reviewing beneficiary designations, and having proper legal documents in place including a will and medical power of attorney. We consider these matters as part of reserves because of their role in managing potential contingencies and preventing costly mistakes from being made.

The RIO Questionnaire prioritizes the importance of reserves in your thinking, and it also surveys your use of, knowledge about, and relevance of these various tactics and tools for your plan.

Retirement Income Funding

The RIO Questionnaire next covers the retirement income funding portion of the RIO-Map, which is expressed in the next column as a series of arrows connecting the retirement assets to the retirement liabilities. This is where you assess the path to your destination. Here you want to explore how well it all comes together, whether you are "on track," and what changes, if any, need to be made to your retirement journey. This is the financial planning portion of your RIO-Map. It is the map's compass to help set you on your course to determine if your preferred tactics are more probability-based or safety-first. It is about making sure that assets are used efficiently to meet goals and cover liabilities. It is also about making sure that you are ready to make any necessary changes over time as your situation and plans evolve.

This analysis moves well beyond just considering the investment portfolio and its asset allocation. For the retirement income funding portion, specific issues we look at include your flexibility about changing your spending habits to achieve other objectives (retirement income flexibility), your outlined plan for success and the coordination of your chosen tactics (retirement funding analysis), your current views about the various financial planning strategies and tactics used to fund retirement income (goal funding